

Fish Scarcity

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Fish scarcity is when a body of water doesn't have as much fishes as it did before—which means the fishes are decreasing in lakes and even at sea.

This happened in multiple countries, for example; Gambia, Chile, Iraq, and even Indonesia.

Even though these were taken from different resources, most of them happened in the year 2020 up to 2025. It's possible that it might still be a problem up until now.

Fish scarcity does not only affect the citizens, it also affects wildlife in some way.

The decreasing numbers in fishes are caused by multiple things, such as; illegal fishing and subsidies. Subsidies are usually the main problem, subsidies are basically support provided to the fishing industry to offset the costs of doing business, this also leads to another problem, which is overcapacity. Overcapacity happens when physical, economic, and technological ability of a fishing fleet harvests more fish than target sustainable. Then there is also illegal fishing, which leads to overfishing. Overfishing is when the rate at which fishes are removed or harvested is faster than the population can naturally reproduce.

The ones impacted by this aren't only humans. In fact, the wildlife may suffer more than us humans. Some of the examples are the following, declining wildlife; years of reckless fishing has

resulted in the decline of important fish stocks such as bluefin tuna and grand banks cod. Hundreds of thousands of marine mammals, seabirds and even sea turtles are captured each year, alongside tens of millions of sharks. Many of these species are endangered and protected.

Degraded ecosystems; overfishing can impact entire ecosystems. It can change the way the fishes reproduce as well as the speed which they mature, when too many fishes are taken from the ocean it creates an imbalance that can lead to the loss of other important marine life, including vulnerable species like sea turtles and corals.

Decreasing food and economic security; demand for fish continues to increase around the world, which means more businesses and jobs rely on fish stocks. Millions of people in developing, coastal communities depend on fishing industry for their livelihood and half of the world's population relies on fish as a major source of protein.

There's no obvious solution into fixing this problem. Even if there is it's more likely to be a small solution and not every country would agree on. First we could make a more strict rule on illegal fishing, we could also reduce the quantity of fleets to harvest fish, and also minimize how much a seller can sell fish at the local market or even at supermarkets.